The B2B inflection: where the growth actually is

The defining shift of 2025-2026 is **the migration of stablecoin volume from retail hedging into business settlement.** It is worth being precise about what is and is not growing. Globally, raw stablecoin transaction volume reached roughly $35 trillion annualized, but **only about $390 billion of that represented genuine real-economy payments** such as vendor invoices, remittances, payroll, and card spending; the rest is trading, internal transfers, and market activity (Source: McKinsey & Artemis, via AMBCrypto). Within that real-payments universe:

B2B transactions

B2B transactions accounted for roughly 60% at $226 billion, up 733% year-on-year, driven primarily by supply-chain payments, cross-border supplier settlement, and treasury liquidity management (Source: McKinsey & Artemis, via AMBCrypto).

Payroll and remittances

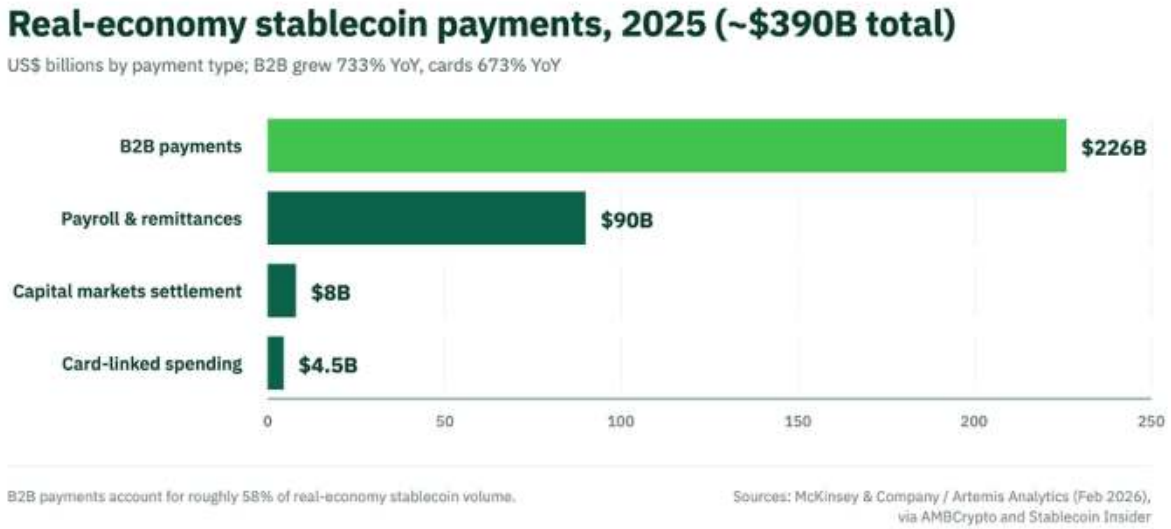
Payroll and remittances contributed roughly $90 billion, capital markets settlement $8 billion, and card-linked spending $4.5 billion, with cards the second-fastest grower at 673% year-on-year (Source: Stablecoin Insider analysis of McKinsey/Artemis data).

B2B volume

Monthly B2B stablecoin volume grew roughly 30-fold in two years, from under $100 million in early 2023 to over $3 billion by 2025 (Source: Artemis / Castle Island Ventures / Dragonfly, via Reap).

Adoption SMEs

Adoption is concentrated among small and medium-sized businesses seeking faster settlement, not just large corporates (Source: The Defiant).



Latam operator data mirrors the global curve almost exactly. **Asia-Latam settlement infrastructure processed 300%+ volume growth in 2025 versus 2024**, driven primarily by import/export and logistics clients, with demand still accelerating: 20%+ growth recorded in the three months to mid-2026 alone, and SMBs now among the fastest-growing client segments by count (Source: VelaFi company data).

The use case seeing the clearest, highest-volume adoption is **supplier payments**, settling invoices to Asian counterparties in stablecoins to avoid correspondent banking delays, FX slippage, and unpredictable settlement windows; **treasury-style** use cases such as liquidity management and FX hedging remain early and limited to a small number of larger clients experimenting with **holding stablecoins as part of broader strategy** (Source: VelaFi company data).

For a small business importing from Asia, **a stablecoin-based supplier payment is the difference between a shipment moving or not** (Source: VelaFi company data).

> Everyone built for the large corporate first and assumed SMBs would follow once the rails matured. We're seeing the opposite: **small businesses with Asia-facing supply chains are adopting faster than anyone, because they're the ones with no alternative.**
>
> No treasury team, no banking relationship that can absorb a slow settlement. They're not early adopters.
> They're the ones with the most to gain.
>
> **HONGYI TANG,**
> **GLOBAL HEAD OF REVENUE, VELAFI**



Adoption segmentation: Retail → B2B → Institutional

The global supply base underpinning this stood at roughly **$300-316 billion in mid-2026**, a 30x increase from mid-2020, with USDT at ~59% and USDC at ~24% of supply (Sources: The Block; Transak, citing DefiLlama). Usage has decoupled from supply: adjusted transaction volume **hit a record $1.79 trillion in June 2026** even as market cap contracted slightly following the GENIUS Act's yield prohibition, evidence that stablecoins are evolving from a hybrid savings-and-spending instrument into a purely transactional one (Source: Crypto Briefing).

Independent industry surveys point the same direction: **adjusted stablecoin transfer volume reached roughly $9 trillion** over the trailing year per a16z's measurement methodology, confirming that transactional usage, not parked supply, is the growth variable (Source: Transak, citing a16z). For Latam specifically, that decoupling is a feature, not a warning sign: the region's demand was always transactional.

Three phases of stablecoin adoption in Latin America

From retail dollar savings to institutional settlement

PHASE	PERIOD	DOMINANT USE CASE	EVIDENCE
Retail	**2020–2023**	Inflation hedging, dollar savings	Retail-sized stablecoin value in Argentina grew faster than any other asset type. Source: Chainalysis
B2B	**2024–present**	Supplier payments, trade settlement, payroll	+733% global B2B growth; 300%+ growth in LATAM corridors. Sources: AMBCrypto; VelaFi company data
Institutional	**Opening now**	Interbank settlement, card-network settlement	Brazil's institutional transfers grew more than 100% period-over-period; Visa launched US USDC settlement in Dec 2025. Sources: Chainalysis; The Asian Banker

Sources: Chainalysis; AMBCrypto; VelaFi company data; The Asian Banker.

Funding snapshot: capital follows the volume

Latam startups raised $4.1 billion in venture capital across 681 rounds in 2025, up 13.8% year-on-year, with fintech capturing 61% of all funding (Source: The StartupVC). Investors explicitly name stablecoins as the driver: 2025 was described by active regional investors as "**all about stablecoins and fintech infrastructure**," and the momentum carried into Q1 2026, when Latam startups raised $1.03 billion, up 12% year-on-year, including a $70 million round for Mexico City-based stablecoin app ARQ co-led by Founders Fund and Sequoia Capital (Source: Crunchbase News).

Card-infrastructure operator Pomelo closed a $55 million Series C backed by Kaszek, Insight Partners, and Index Ventures before launching stablecoin-denominated card programs (Source: Scenius Latam).

The funding pattern matches the volume pattern: capital is flowing to the infrastructure layers, not to token speculation.

Where LATAM venture capital went in 2025

$4.1B raised across 681 rounds, up 13.8% year-on-year — fintech took 61%

SHARE OF 2025 FUNDING

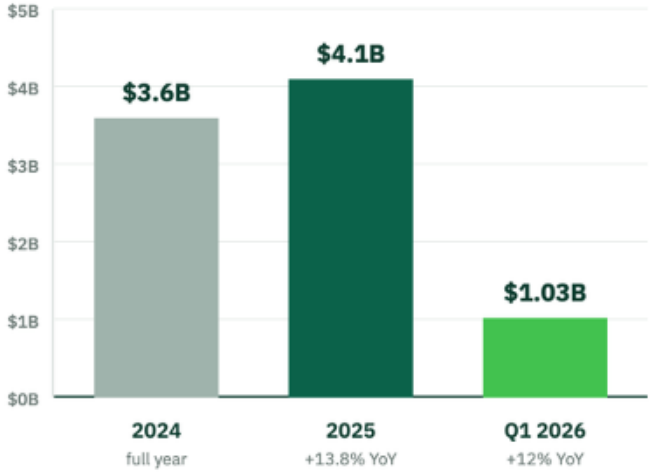


681
Rounds closed in 2025

$4.1B
Total venture capital raised in 2025

+13.8%
Year-on-year growth in capital raised

FUNDING RAISED, US$ BILLIONS



RECENT INFRASTRUCTURE ROUNDS

$70M	ARQ, Mexico City stablecoin app — co-led by Founders Fund and Sequoia Capital
$55M	Pomelo Series C — Kaszek, Insight Partners, Index Ventures; launching stablecoin-denominated card programs

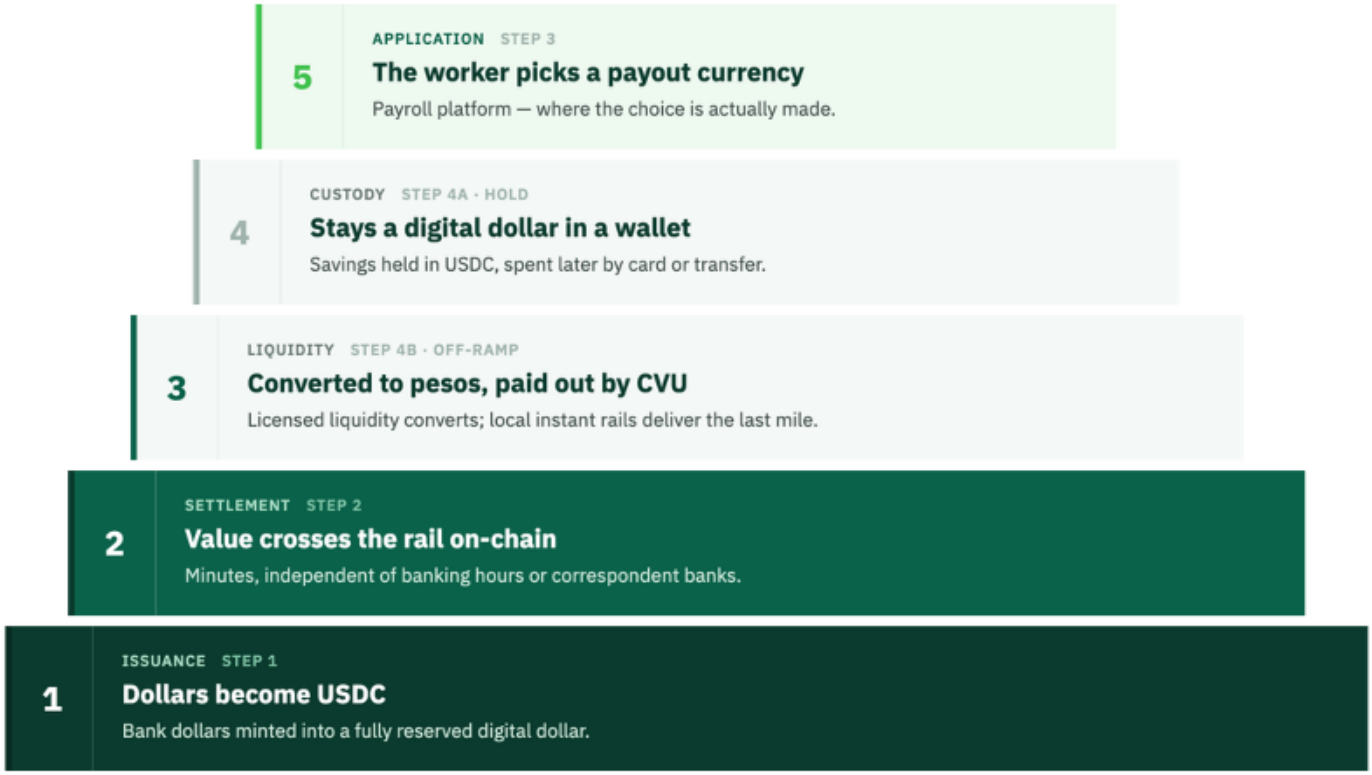
Capital is concentrating in payment and card infrastructure rather than token speculation.

Sources: The StartupVC; Crunchbase News; Scenius LATAM

4

The Infrastructure

The Infrastructure Stack: How the Five Layers Connect



Layer 1 (Issuance): who mints the dollars

USDT and USDC together account for more than 90% of stablecoin transfer volume on regional exchanges, with USD-pegged tokens rising from around 60% of activity in 2022 to more than 90% in 2025; **for cross-border and treasury use cases, USD tokens are the natural default**, offering deep liquidity, near-universal acceptance, and a shared unit of account for international commerce (Source: Bitget). Both issuers now operate under formal law in their home jurisdictions: the US GENIUS Act, enacted in July 2025, established the first federal framework for payment stablecoins, mandating reserve standards and prohibiting yield payments to holders (Source: Forbes). **Local-currency stablecoins, notably BRL-pegged tokens integrated with PIX, are an emerging but still small category** (Source: Phoenix Strategy Group).

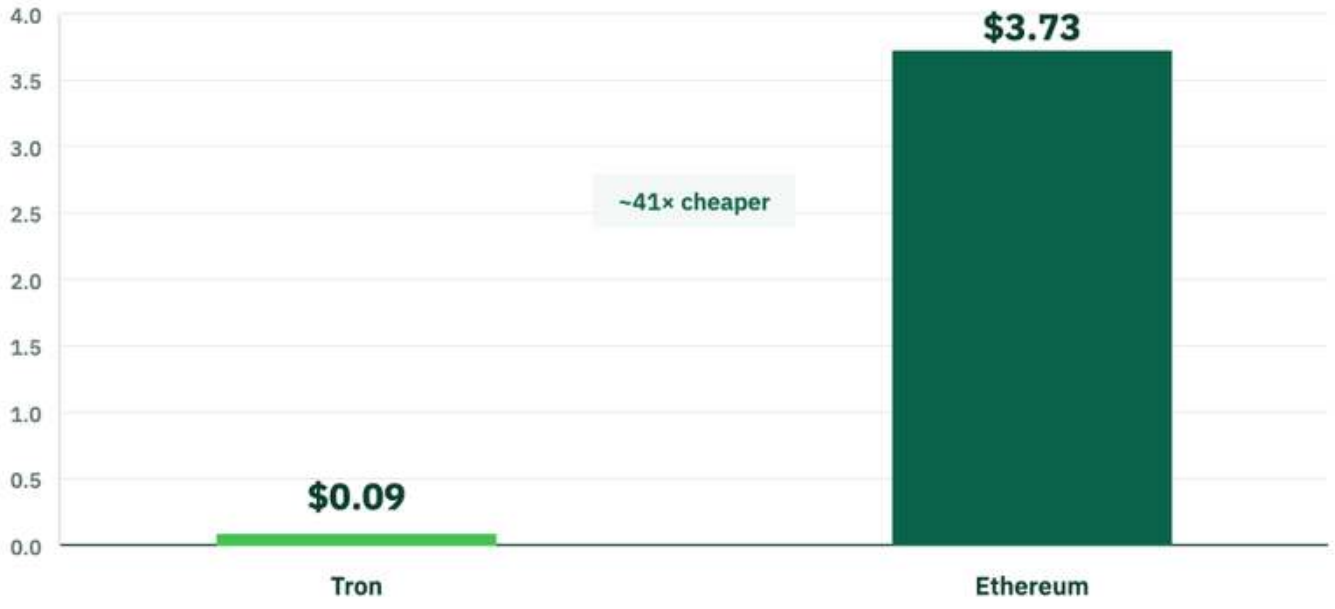
Layer 2 (Settlement rails): Chains and Networks

The chains Latam uses diverge sharply from crypto-industry attention:

RAIL	ROLE IN LATAM	KEY DATA
Tron	Default retail and remittance rail	▪ 65% of global retail USDT transfers (under $1,000) ▪ $7.9T in USDT transfers in 2025 ▪ More than 40% of Brazil's USDT transfers ▪ ~$0.09 median fee vs. $3.73 on Ethereum
Ethereum + L2s	Institutional settlement, DeFi collateral	▪ Largest chain by stablecoin supply
Solana	Fast-growing consumer and institutional rail	▪ Carries Visa's US USDC settlement

Why Tron carries LATAM's retail stablecoin flows

Median USDT transfer fee in USD; Tron also holds 65% of global retail (under $1,000) USDT transfers



A $200 remittance costs about 0.05% to move on Tron versus roughly 1.9% on Ethereum.

Sources: Arkham Research (fees); CoinDesk Research, TRON Network Q3 2025 (retail transfer share)

Regulated networks

A second kind of settlement rail matters just as much: **permissioned networks that embed stablecoins inside existing institutional plumbing**. The Circle Payments Network (CPN), launched in April 2025 as a coordination layer for banks, PSPs, and VASPs, **reached $8.3 billion in annualized transaction volume by March 2026**, and its Managed Payments product, launched April 2026, lets institutions settle in USDC while interacting entirely in fiat (Sources: Circle / PR Newswire; Bitcoin.com News).

This is where the region's legacy remittance infrastructure connects to on-chain settlement. **A network connecting 50+ money transmitters, banks, and 90,000+ payout locations**, historically reliant exclusively on correspondent banking, now routes both traditional and stablecoin rails through a single integration, with stablecoin settlement embedded as one more option the system can choose per transaction rather than a replacement (Source: Movantis company data).

Stablecoins add the most value on the **interbank and inter-correspondent leg**, the movement of value between institutions where speed of settlement and capital efficiency matter most, while **the last mile into local currency continues to run predominantly on regulated local rails**, because that is where the beneficiary actually receives the value (Source: Movantis company data).

> In cross-border transactions, technology stopped being a constraint. What decides who scales in Latam is regulated standing on both ends of the corridor, and that is built over years, not bought.
>
> **Stablecoins do not remove that requirement. They run on top of it.**
>
> **GUSTAVO RUIZ,**
> **CHAIRMAN & CEO, MOVANTIS**

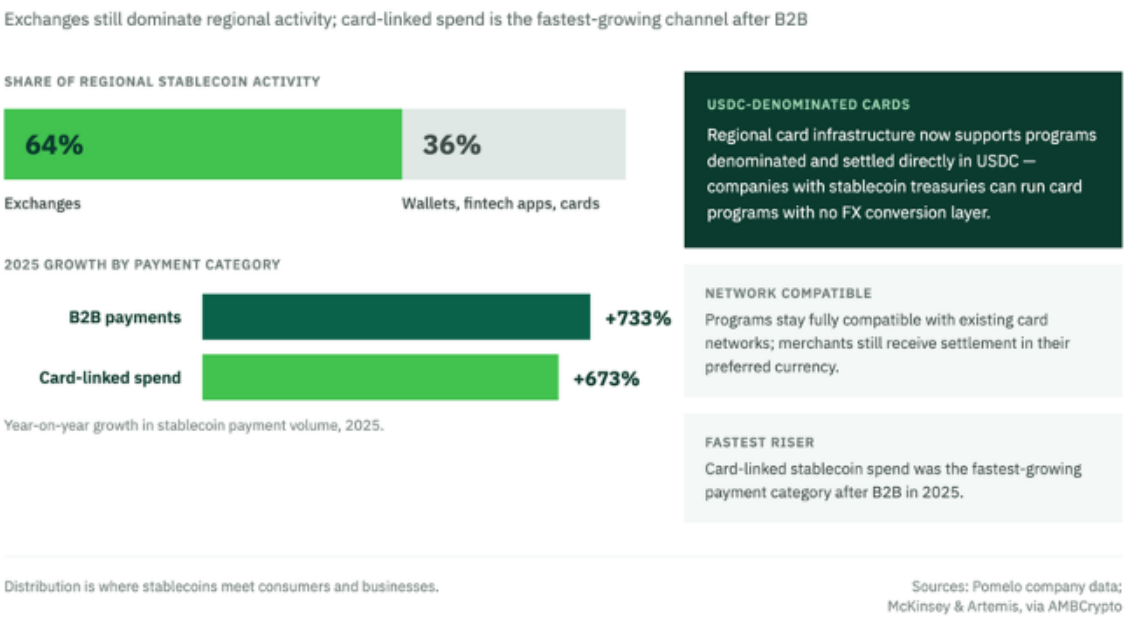


Layer 3 (On/off-ramps and liquidity): where fragmentation becomes engineering

The ramp layer converts between on-chain dollars and local currency, and it is where Latam's fragmentation becomes a build problem rather than a talking point. **Every corridor requires local liquidity, licensed conversion, and integration with each destination's domestic rail**: PIX in Brazil, SPEI in Mexico, CVU in Argentina, Bre-B in Colombia; infrastructure without that context fails operationally even when it works technically (Source: VelaFi company data). For B2B flows, trade-settlement platforms occupy this layer, giving importers and exporters same-day conversion between local currency and stablecoin-settled supplier payments across Latin America, Asia, and the US (Source: Mandioca company data).

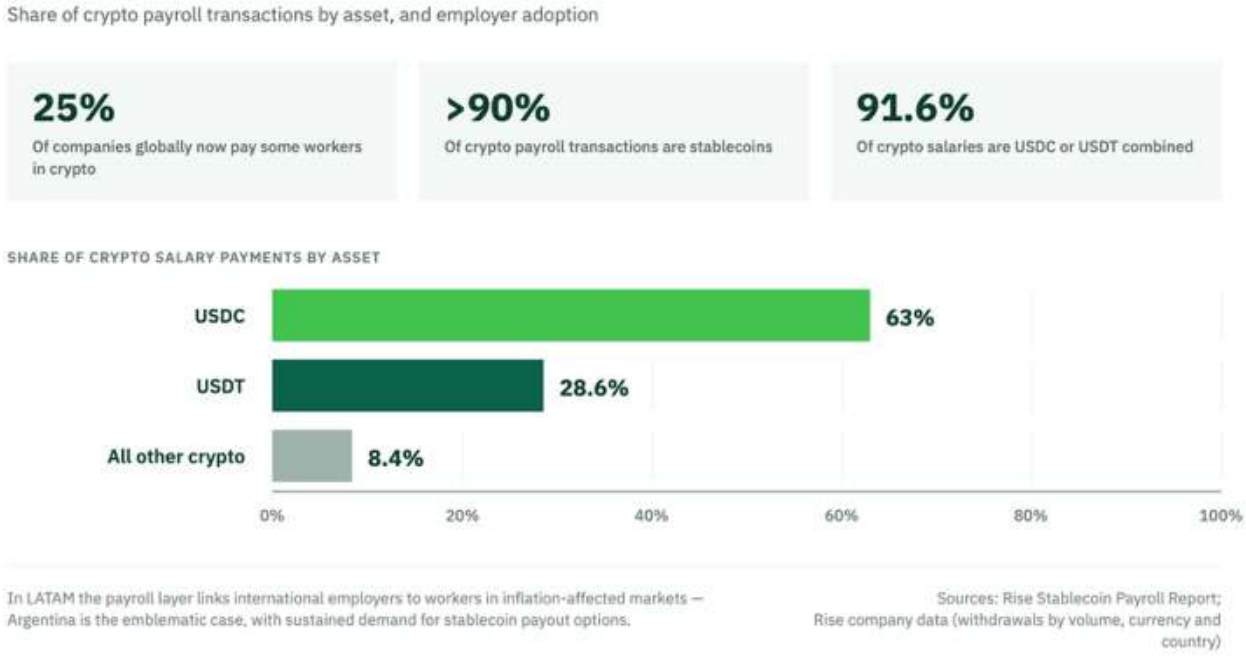
Layer 4 (Distribution): exchanges, wallets, and the card bridge

Distribution is where stablecoins meet consumers and businesses: **exchanges (64% of regional activity), wallets, fintech apps, and increasingly cards.** Regional card infrastructure now supports programs denominated and settled directly in USDC, letting companies with stablecoin treasuries run card programs with no FX conversion layer while remaining fully compatible with existing card networks; merchants continue receiving settlement in their preferred currency (Source: Pomelo company data). **Card-linked stablecoin spend was the fastest-growing payment category after B2B, up 673% year-on-year in 2025** (Source: McKinsey & Artemis, via AMBCrypto).



Layer 5 (Payroll): how on-chain dollars become recurring income

The payroll layer sits directly above distribution: it is how on-chain dollars become recurring income rather than one-off transfers. **Globally, 25% of companies now pay some workers in cryptocurrency; stablecoins account for over 90% of crypto payroll transactions**, with USDC alone holding a 63% share of crypto salaries and USDT 28.6% (Source: Rise Stablecoin Payroll Report). In Latam, the payroll layer connects international employers to workers in inflation-affected markets, with platform withdrawal data tracked by volume, currency (fiat and stablecoin), and country showing sustained regional demand for stablecoin payout options, Argentina being the emblematic case (Source: Rise company data).



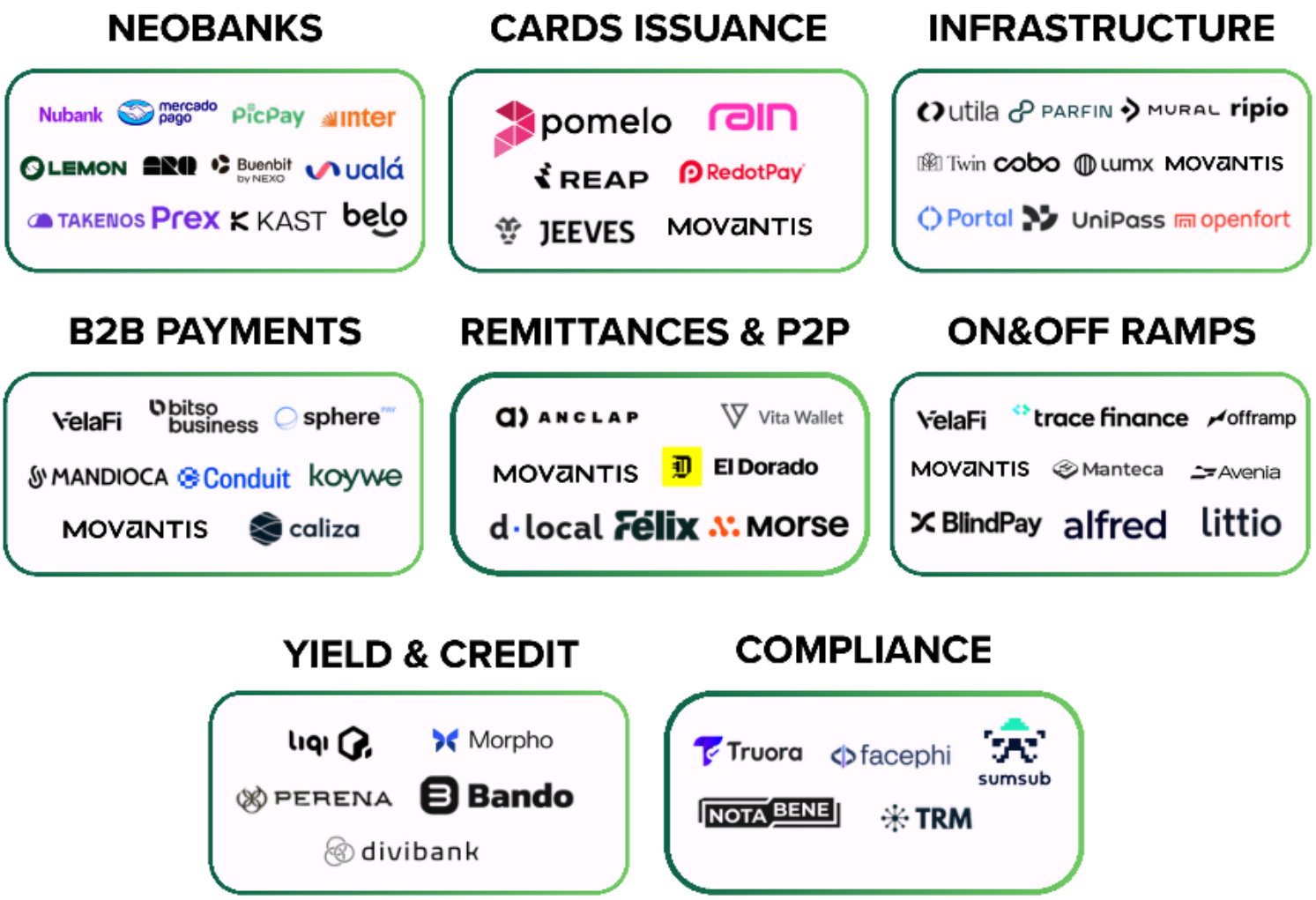
Anatomy of one transaction: how the layers physically connect

A US company pays a contractor in Buenos Aires. Dollars become USDC (Layer 1), cross a settlement rail (Layer 2), reach a payroll platform (Layer 5) where the worker selects a payout currency, and are either held as digital dollars in a wallet (Layer 4) or off-ramped through licensed liquidity into pesos via CVU transfer (Layer 3). The identical anatomy, with the settlement leg on-chain and the disbursement leg on local rails, appears in a $250,000 supplier payment to Shenzhen and a $500 salary payout to Córdoba. Structural repetition across ticket sizes five orders of magnitude apart is the strongest evidence available that this is general-purpose settlement infrastructure rather than a niche product.

5

The Ecosystem Map

THE LATAM STABLECOIN ECOSYSTEM MAP 2026



Chiara Munaretto
Stablecoin Insider

x pomelo

The five case studies that follow profile one operator per critical layer, each using the same template: snapshot, what it does, key data, corridor/market context, why it matters, leadership view.

Case Study: Mandioca

Stablecoin Settlement for Real Trade

Mandioca facilitates cross-border B2B payments for importers and exporters across Latin America, Asia, and the United States, using stablecoin infrastructure as the settlement layer between local-currency legs on each side (Source: Mandioca company data).

Since inception, the platform has processed over U**SD 1 billion in transaction volume across more than 100 enterprise clients, with over 90% of volume tied to real trade activity**: supplier payments, inventory purchases, and international procurement. Typical transaction sizes range from **USD 20,000 to USD 250,000, with many enterprise transactions exceeding those amounts. The fastest-growing corridors are Latam→China, Latam→Hong Kong, US→Latam, and China→Latam.** Settlement falls from 2-5 business days via correspondent banking to same-day, often minutes, with nearly all transactions completed within 24 hours (Source: Mandioca company data).

Mandioca's flows sit squarely in the fastest-growing category of the global market: B2B supplier payments, **which grew 733% worldwide in 2025** (Source: The Defiant). Its client base spans the region's two clearest macro stress cases: Bolivian importers **navigating 80-95% parallel-market dollar premiums** and Colombian importers **absorbing roughly 15% annual peso depreciation** (Source: Mandioca company data).

The operating insight is that adoption is driven by dollar access as much as speed. Businesses across the region increasingly use stablecoins not as a crypto product but as a practical way to access, hold, and transfer dollar-denominated value; the resulting benefits, faster access to global liquidity, reduced settlement friction, and a more predictable mechanism for paying international suppliers, translate directly into working capital, since businesses no longer pre-fund accounts across jurisdictions or hold excess capital against settlement delays (Source: Mandioca company data).

Stablecoins are becoming the financial infrastructure behind international trade.

Most businesses using our platform do not think about blockchain at all. They simply expect money to move as fast as information.

The winners in this market will be the companies that make the technology invisible while delivering better outcomes for global commerce.

Leandro Meneses

Founder & CEO, Mandioca

Case Study: Movantis

Stablecoins Inside Regulated Remittance Infrastructure

"Movantis" is a trademark used to represent the collective capabilities, products, and services offered by Transnetwork LLC and its subsidiaries ("Movantis"). Movantis operates the regulated infrastructure layer connecting money transmitters, banks, and payout locations across the region; a layer no other operator in this region occupies.

Built on more than 20 years of operating depth in the U.S.-Latam corridor, it routes both traditional and stablecoin rails through a single integration, with stablecoin settlement embedded as one more "per-transaction" option, rather than a replacement of the legacy network. Movantis operates a U.S.-licensed money transmitter that acts as an Originating Financial Institution (OFI), while also operating Beneficiary Financial Institutions (BFI) across Latam markets. Movantis is also a member of the Circle Payments Network. Beyond settlement, institutions can access card issuing, white-label wallet infrastructure, FX and liquidity management, and virtual accounts, each delivered by the corresponding regulated entity (Source: Movantis company data).

Through regulated subsidiaries, Movantis holds **60+ licenses** across the Americas, including active money transmission licensing across all 50 U.S. states, and operational standing in 15+ Latam markets, **connecting 50+ money transmitters and banks** to 90,000+ payout locations and 250,000+ cash locations, processing $63B+ in annual volume and **200M+ transactions**. Stablecoin settlement through the Circle Payments Network is concentrated on the interbank leg, where 24/7 availability eliminates batch windows and prefunding requirements (Source: Movantis company data; Circle).

The network sits at the intersection of the two structural dynamics this report documents: the growth of digital stablecoin rails and the persistence of physical last-mile infrastructure. Those two things are not in tension; they are the architecture. The stablecoin leg handles institutional settlement where it performs best; the local rail network handles last-mile delivery through regulated entities where no blockchain reaches without licensed presence (Sources: BBVA Research; Banxico; Movantis company data).

Licensing, local liquidity, and last-mile connectivity take years to build and cannot be accelerated with capital. **For institutions connecting through the Movantis network, that compliance infrastructure, built and held by regulated subsidiaries across each jurisdiction, is already in place rather than assembled market by market.**

Stablecoins solved the value movement.

They didn't solve landing it in local currency, compliantly, across every market in the region.

In Latam, the last mile is still the hardest mile, and it doesn't run on-chain.

Gustavo Ruiz,

Chairman & CEO, Movantis

Case Study: Pomelo

Cards as Bridge to Everyday Spending

Pomelo has built card-issuing infrastructure that adapts to each market's regulatory, payment, and credit specifics: it first consolidated local issuing across Latin America and now issues globally across 150+ countries through a single integration, with debit, prepaid, and credit programs settling in local currency, USD, or USDC depending on the use case (Source: Pomelo company data).

Local cards issued within a specific country typically see around 80% domestic and 20% cross-border transactions, benefiting from lower interchange on most of their volume; global cards issued from a single jurisdiction run 90-95% cross-border. **Domestic transactions cost approximately 5-15% of what cross-border transactions cost, creating fundamentally different unit economics between the two models.** For companies with stablecoin treasuries, settling card programs directly in USDC, whether local or global, eliminates FX conversion costs entirely (Source: Pomelo company data).

The card layer addresses the region's clearest structural gap: Latam operates in a multi-rail reality where cash, cards, real-time systems like PIX, and stablecoins coexist, each serving different use cases, and while stablecoins excel at cross-border movement and treasury operations, cards remain the dominant interface for everyday consumer spending. **With 64% of regional crypto activity on centralized exchanges, the region is primed for infrastructure connecting on-chain holdings to off-chain spend** (Source: Pomelo company data, citing Chainalysis). **Globally, card-linked stablecoin volume grew 673% in 2025** (Source: AMBCrypto).

The strategic playbook the infrastructure enables, launching global cards to validate demand quickly across multiple markets and then layering in local cards as specific countries reach scale, is only possible on rails-agnostic infrastructure, and it is the practical mechanism by which the region's holding-to-spending transition gets built (Source: Pomelo company data).

Latam operates across multiple payment rails: cards, account-to-account, and now stablecoins.

It's a multi-rail ecosystem in a complex region defined by regulatory asymmetries across markets.

The opportunity isn't about picking a winning rail; it's about combining them intelligently.

Gastón Irigoyen

CEO & Co-Founder, Pomelo